

# PrimeFocus

October 2025



## WHEN

October 17, 2025

Doors open at 7:00pm

Meeting starts at 7:30pm

Lecture starts at 8:00pm

## WHERE

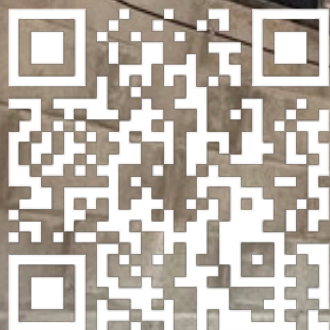
Unitarian Church

1893 North Vasco Road

Livermore, CA 945571

and via Zoom

## TVS QR CODE



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## NEWS AND NOTES

### Meeting Dates

| Club Meeting | Board Meeting | PrimeFocus Deadline |
|--------------|---------------|---------------------|
| October 17   | October 20    | October 4           |
| November 21  | November 24   | November 8          |
| December 19  | December 22   | December 6          |

### Money Matters

As of the last Treasurer's Report on 9/22/25, our club's account balance is \$46,221.04, this includes \$11,105.46 in the H2O Rebuild fund.

### TVS Welcomes New Members

TVS welcomes new members Colin Lambert, Andrew Sneegas, Will Bekker, Paul Caffrey, and Robert Brundage. Please say hello and chat with them during our meetings.

### 2025 TVS Club Star Party Schedule

Save the dates for the 2025 Club Star Parties.

Del Valle star parties are also public outreach events. They are jointly hosted with the EBRPD and held at the Arroyo Staging Area (Coords: 37.6196638, -121.7528899). The public is invited for the first 1.5-2 hours, while club members can stay the remainder of the night.

### No events currently scheduled for Del Valle.

Tesla Vintners star parties are open to only club members and their guests. These star parties end at midnight, but participants can leave earlier, should they wish.

### No events currently scheduled for Tesla Vintners.

H2O Open House star parties are open to only club members and their guests. The open house ends at midnight, and all participants are encouraged to stay the duration. The drive to H2O takes about 1 hour, and the caravan leaves promptly from the corner of Mines and Tesla Rds. No gas stations are available on the route, so be prepared. Admission is \$3/car-bring exact change. H2O is a primitive site with two porta-potties. Bring water, food, and warm clothing, as needed. Red flashlights are to be used so observers can preserve their night vision.

### No events currently scheduled for H2O.

**October 25:** Moon and possibly solar viewing at Del Valle Visitor Center, 7000 Del Valle Rd, Livermore. 4:00pm - 7:00pm. Del Valle is having a fall event from 4pm to 7pm and will be located at the visitor center on the west shore of the lake. The moon is several days past new so we can view that. If someone has a solar scope they want to bring, I am sure they would enjoy that too. The event will be over before darkness falls, so we wouldn't need too many volunteers.

**November 7:** School Star Party at Valley Christian School, 7500 Inspiration Drive, Dublin. Set-up 5:00pm, Observing from 5:45-8:45pm

**November 14:** School Star Party at Kolb Elementary School, 3150 Palermo Way, Dublin. Set-up 5:00pm, Observing from 5:45-8:45pm

## CALENDAR OF EVENTS



**October 17, 18, 24, 25,, 31 November 1, 7, 8, 14, 15, 7:30-10:30pm**

|       |                                                                        |
|-------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| What  | Free Telescope Viewing                                                 |
| Who   | Chabot Staff                                                           |
| Where | Chabot Space and Science Center, 10000 Skyline Blvd. Oakland, CA 94619 |
| Cost  | Free                                                                   |

Join Chabot astronomers on the Observatory Deck for a free telescope viewing! Weather permitting, this is a chance to explore stars, planets and more through Chabot's historic telescopes. Chabot's three large historic telescopes offer a unique way to experience the awe and wonder of the Universe. Three observatory domes house the Center's 8-inch (Leah, 1883) and 20-inch (Rachel, 1916) refracting telescopes, along with a 36-inch reflecting telescope (Nellie, 2003).

Are the skies clear for viewing tonight? Viewing can be impacted by rain, clouds, humidity and other weather conditions. Conditions can be unique to Chabot because of its unique location in Joaquin Miller Park. Before your visit, check out the Weather Station to see the current conditions at Chabot.

For more information, see  
<https://chabotspace.org/events/events-listing/>  
<https://eastbayastro.org/chabot-telescope-status/>

## November 3, 7:30 PM

|       |                                                                         |
|-------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| What  | Our Marvelous Magnetic Moon                                             |
| Who   | California Academy of Sciences                                          |
| Where | Morrison Planetarium; 55 Music Concourse Drive, San Francisco, CA 94118 |
| Cost  | Public: \$15; Members and seniors: \$12                                 |

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Featuring Dr. Megan Seritan, SETI Institute

From lunar samples returned by the Apollo missions in the 1960s and 1970s to measurements taken from satellites orbiting the Moon in the present day, we've learned that the Moon used to have a global magnetic field just like the Earth does today. At some point, this global field disappeared. When and why did it vanish, and what traces did it leave behind on the lunar surface for us to find? This talk will discuss our knowledge of the Moon's magnetic history, how we've arrived at it, and what's next on our journey of discovery.

Dr. Megan Seritan is a planetary scientist and archivist at the SETI Institute. She received her B.S. in physics from UC Santa Barbara and her Ph.D. in planetary science from UC Santa Cruz, with a dissertation titled "The Geologic Context of Lunar Magnetic Anomalies". At the SETI Institute, Megan is the Deputy Manager of Ring-Moon Systems Node of NASA's planetary science data archive, the Planetary Data System (PDS). In her work for the PDS, Megan archives data from NASA's planetary science missions for future generations of scientists.



This photo, taken by Lunar Orbiter in 1966, shows a lunar swirl: pale streaks on the Moon's surface where the magnetic field is anomalously high. This particular lunar swirl is Reiner Gamma, located on the Moon's nearside. The field of view in this photo is about 70 miles wide.

For more information, see <https://www.calacademy.org/events/benjamin-dean-astronomy-lectures/our-marvelous-magnetic-moon>

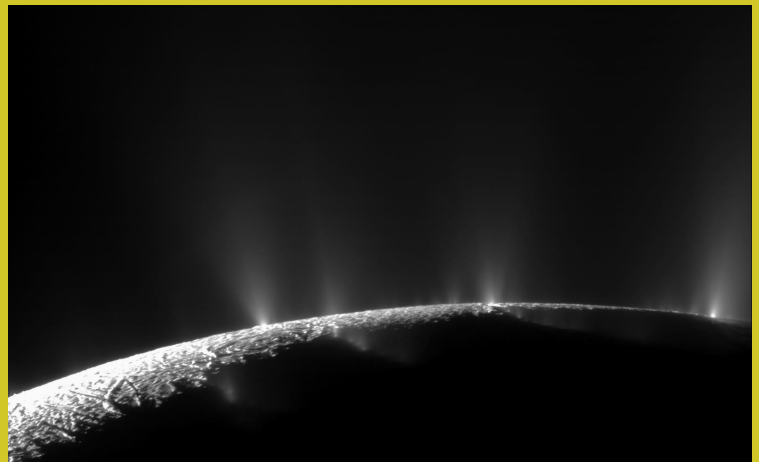
## November 19, 7:00 PM

|       |                                                                                                                                       |
|-------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| What  | The Search for Life on Saturn's Intriguing Moon Enceladus                                                                             |
| Who   | Silicon Valley Astronomy Lecture Series                                                                                               |
| Where | Smithwick Theater at Foothill College (Bldg. 1000), Foothill College is just off the El Monte Road exit from Freeway 280 in Los Altos |
| Cost  | Free                                                                                                                                  |

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The talk is part of the Silicon Valley Astronomy Lecture Series, now in its 26th year.

In 2005, the Cassini spacecraft made a groundbreaking discovery—it found a massive plume of ice and gas erupting from the south pole of Enceladus, a small but geologically active moon of Saturn. The plume is now believed to originate from a subsurface ocean of liquid water beneath the moon's icy crust, with conditions compatible with life, as we know it. This talk will focus on our current understanding of Enceladus' plume and subsurface ocean, and on strategies to search in them for possible evidence of life.



Enceladus with plumes. Image credit: NASA

Alfonso Davila is a Research Scientist in the Exobiology branch at NASA Ames Research Center, where he helps develop strategies to search for evidence of life beyond Earth. He also conducts theoretical and experimental research on the nature and distribution of life in Earth environments that are considered analogous to extraterrestrial settings. His work investigates factors that affect biological potential and biosignature preservation in those environments. He has been a guest speaker at international conferences and a guest lecturer in universities and research institutes in the US, Canada, South America and Europe.

For more information, see <https://astrosociety.org/get-involved/events/event-calendar.html/calendar/2025/11>



**NGC 2070, The Tarantula Nebula**, By Mark Hai Du.  
For full size image, see <https://app.astrobin.com/i/qeiv2k>



## WHATS UP

Adapted from Sky and Telescope

All times are Pacific Standard Time

### October 2025

|           |            |                                                                 |
|-----------|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| 19        | Sun        | at dawn, the thin crescent moon is just 4° upper right of Venus |
| 20-21     | Mon-Tue    | All night see the Orionid meteor shower                         |
| <b>21</b> | <b>Tue</b> | <b>New Moon</b>                                                 |
| 22        | Wed        | Autumn begins at 11:19AM                                        |
| 27        | Mon        | At dusk moon is just 3° just left of Antares                    |
| 29        | Wed        | Moon is at first quarter                                        |

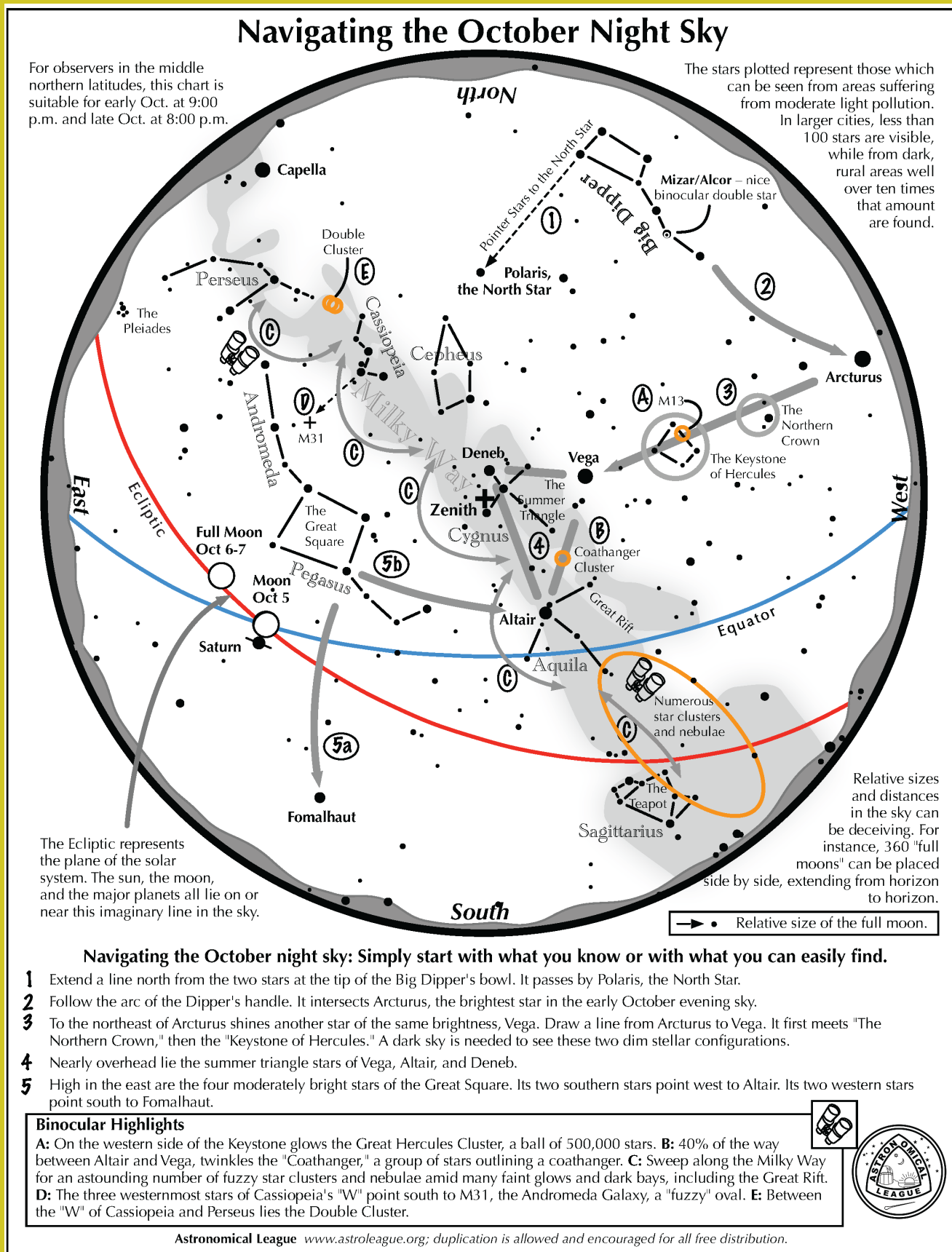
### November 2025

|          |            |                                                                                                                           |
|----------|------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2        | Sun        | Daylight savings time ends at 2am                                                                                         |
| <b>5</b> | <b>Wed</b> | <b>Full Moon</b>                                                                                                          |
| 6        | Thu        | Evening look for the Moon trailing the Pleiades by just 6°                                                                |
| 9        | Sun        | Looking east in the evening, see the moon just 3° lower right of Pollux and Jupiter is just 4° lower right of the Moon.   |
| 12       | Wed        | Moon is at last quarter                                                                                                   |
| 13       | Thu        | In the Morning the Moon follows Regulus by just 4½° to the east                                                           |
| 16       | Sun        | In the morning the moon leads Regulus by 4° while it rises in the East                                                    |
| 17       | Mon        | In the morning the Leonid meteor shower peaks, see page 50 in the November 20025 issue of Sky and Telescope for more info |

## OFFICERS AND VOLUNTEER POSITIONS

| <b>Officers</b>                                                              | <b>Volunteer Positions</b>                                                                    | <b>Newsletter</b>                                                                                | <b>Potluck Coordinator</b>                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>President</b><br>Eric Dueltgen<br>president@trivalleystargazers.org       | <b>Astronomical League Rep.</b><br>Don Dossa<br>alrep@trivalleystargazers.org                 | Scott Schneider (Editor)<br>newsletter@trivalleystargazers.org                                   | OPEN<br>potluck@trivalleystargazers.org                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>Vice-President</b><br>Aris Pope<br>vice_president@trivalleystargazers.org | <b>Club Star Party Coordinator</b><br>Johnathan Bailey<br>coordinator@trivalleystargazers.org | <b>Webmaster</b><br>Swaroop Shere<br>webmaster@trivalleystargazers.org                           | <b>Program Coordinator</b><br>Ron Kane<br>programs@trivalleystargazers.org                                                                                                                                               |
| <b>Treasurer</b><br>John Forrest<br>treasurer@trivalleystargazers.org        | <b>Del Valle Coordinator</b><br>David Wright<br>delvalle@trivalleystargazers.org              | <b>Night Sky Network Rep.</b><br>Ross Gaunt<br>nnsn@trivalleystargazers.org                      | <b>Publicity and Fundraising</b><br>OPEN<br>publicity@trivalleystargazers.org                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>Secretary</b><br>Dave Lackey<br>secretary@trivalleystargazers.org         | <b>Historian</b><br>OPEN<br>historian@trivalleystargazers.org                                 | <b>H2O Observatory Director / Rebuild Chairman</b><br>Chuck Grant<br>H20@trivalleystargazers.org | <b>Refreshment Coordinator</b><br>OPEN                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>Past President</b><br>Ron Kane<br>past_president@trivalleystargazers.org  | <b>Librarian</b><br>Ron Kane<br>librarian@trivalleystargazers.org                             | <b>Observing Program Coordinator</b><br>Ron Kane<br>awards@trivalleystargazers.org               | <b>Web and Email</b><br>www.trivalleystargazers.org<br>info@trivalleystargazers.org                                                                                                                                      |
|                                                                              | <b>Loaner Scope Manager</b><br>Ron Kane<br>telescopes@trivalleystargazers.org                 | <b>Outreach Coordinator</b><br>Johnathan Bailey<br>outreach@trivalleystargazers.org              | <b>TVS E-Group</b><br>To Join the TVS E-Group just send an email to TVS at info@trivalleystargazers.org asking to join the group. Make sure you specify the email address you want to use to read and post to the group. |

## NAVIGATING THE NIGHT SKY FOR OCTOBER 2025





Tri-Valley Stargazers  
P.O. Box 2476  
Livermore, CA 94551  
[www.trivalleystargazers.org](http://www.trivalleystargazers.org)

## Tri-Valley Stargazers Membership Application

### Contact information:

Name: \_\_\_\_\_ Phone: \_\_\_\_\_

Street Address: \_\_\_\_\_

City, State, Zip: \_\_\_\_\_

Email Address: \_\_\_\_\_

Status (select one): \_\_\_\_\_ New member \_\_\_\_\_ Renewing or returning member

**Membership category** (select one): Membership term is for one calendar year, January through December.

\_\_\_\_\_ Student member (\$10). Must be a full-time high-school or college student.

\_\_\_\_\_ Regular member (\$30).

**Hidden Hill Observatory Access** (optional): Must be 18 or older.

\_\_\_\_\_ One-time key deposit (\$20). This is a refundable deposit for a key to H2O. New key holders must first hear an orientation lecture and sign a usage agreement form before using the observing site.

\_\_\_\_\_ Annual access fee (\$10). You must also be a key holder to access the site.

**Donation** (optional):

\_\_\_\_\_ Tax-deductible contribution to Tri-Valley Stargazers

**Total enclosed:** \$ \_\_\_\_\_

Member agrees to hold Tri-Valley Stargazers, and any cooperating organizations or landowners, harmless from all claims of liability for any injury or loss sustained at a TVS function. TVS will not share information with anyone except as detailed in our Privacy Policy (<http://www.trivalleystargazers.org/privacy.shtml>).

Mail this completed form along with a check to: Tri-Valley Stargazers, P.O. Box 2476, Livermore, CA 94551.